

1. Background and Rationale

Across many African countries, a persistent gap exists between education and leadership readiness. While thousands of young people graduate each year with strong academic qualifications, a significant proportion lack structured pathways into policy, governance, civic leadership, and high-impact professional careers.

This gap is not only academic, but also systemic. Students are often equipped with theoretical knowledge but have limited exposure to real-world policy thinking, governance structures, career navigation strategies, and leadership development opportunities. As a result, talent is abundant, but direction and access remain uneven. **EduLead Network** is founded on the belief that education must go beyond certification. It must actively prepare young people to lead, govern, and transform society.

2. Vision

To develop a generation of young leaders who are equipped with skills, confidence, and networks to shape policy, governance, and societal transformation.

3. Mission

EduLead Network exists to bridge the gap between education and leadership by providing structured mentorship, policy exposure, and career development support to young people transitioning from education into public service, governance, and impact-driven careers.

4. Objectives

EduLead Network seeks to:

- Strengthen the leadership and civic capacity of about 1000 young people through structured mentorship and training in its first year
- Support young people in accessing scholarships, fellowships, internships, and global opportunities.
- Provide guidance on careers in public policy, governance, international development, and leadership pathways

- Equip about 1,500 students with practical skills in policy writing, research, public speaking, and critical thinking in its first year

5. Core Activities

EduLead Network will operate through a hybrid model combining online and in-person engagement:

a. Mentorship & Coaching

- One-on-one and group mentorship sessions
- Career guidance and transition support
- Guidance on accessing opportunities (scholarships, fellowship, etc.)
- Personal leadership development coaching

b. Policy & Leadership Training

- Introductory policy analysis workshops
- Governance and Civic Leadership Seminars
- Writing and communication training for policy briefs

c. Youth Policy Dialogue Series

- Conversations with policymakers, academics, and development practitioners
- Virtual and in-person forums on education, governance, and youth inclusion

6. Target Beneficiaries

EduLead Network is designed for:

- S.H.S, university students and graduates
- Young professionals interested in policy, governance, and public leadership
- First-generation students navigating global opportunities

7. Expected Impact

EduLead Network aims to:

- Improve access to leadership and policy careers for young people
- Strengthen youth participation in governance and civic processes
- Increase successful applications to global scholarships and fellowships
- Build a pipeline of informed, ethical, and capable future leaders
- Reduce the disconnect between education systems and labor market leadership needs

8. Conclusion

EduLead Network is a structured response to a critical gap between education and leadership readiness. It seeks to redefine what it means to be “educated” by ensuring that learning is directly connected to leadership, governance, and societal impact.

In a rapidly changing global environment, where policy decisions shape the future of economies and societies, EduLead Network positions young people not as passive beneficiaries of systems, but as active architects of change.